Portfolio Kanban & Investment Mix

Limit how many big initiatives run at once, decide with a lean business case, and keep investment balanced.

Lead the Organisation · Lean Portfolio Management · Limit Portfolio WIP · Stop Starting, Start Finishing

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

PORTFOLIO: Online grocery

DATE: 6 May

1 Portfolio Kanban

ONE STICKY PER INITIATIVE · PULL, DON'T PUSH

Funnel

Every new idea lands here

Exit when: a sponsor and a problem

- Family accounts
- Voice ordering
- Recipe-to-basket

Reviewing

Worth a closer look?

WIP limit: 4

Exit when: fits strategy; worth a case

- Personalised offers
- Loyalty rewards

Analysing

Lean business case

WIP limit: 2

Exit when: lean case approved

- Staples subscriptions
- New payment provider

Ready

Approved, waiting for capacity

WIP limit: 3

Exit when: a team has capacity

- Delivery Slots team

Implementing

MVP first, then persevere or pivot

WIP limit: 3

Exit when: MVP outcome measured

- Reorder made easy
- Smart substitutes
- Faster checkout

Done

Outcome measured

Exit when: benefits reviewed

- Self-service deploys

2 Lean Business Case

ONE PAGE PER INITIATIVE IN ANALYSING

Initiative: Staples subscriptions

Problem or opportunity: families run out of staples between weekly shops

Hypothesis

We believe… a staples subscription for weekly shoppers

will result in… repeat orders up 3 points, fewer second orders

We'll know when… 5,000 active subscriptions by the end of Q3

Smallest version (MVP): a manual subscription for 50 customers, 4 weeks

Cost range: £40k–£70k to build fully

Cost of delay: ☑ High ☐ Medium ☐ Low

Go / no-go criteria: go if 70% keep it for 4 weeks in the manual test

Decision: ☑ Go to Ready ☐ Not now ☐ Stop

3 Investment Mix

AGREE THE SPLIT UP FRONT

TYPE OF WORK	TARGET %	ACTUAL %
New bets	15	10
Grow existing	45	55
Run & maintain	20	20
Tech debt & enablers	15	10
Unplanned buffer	5	5
Total = 100%	100	100

Too little on new bets and tech debt

Is the actual mix what we intended?

4 Portfolio Review

Review cadence: monthly

Decision forum: the portfolio group

- ☑ WIP limits respected
- ☑ Stop something to start something
- ☐ Funding checked against outcomes
- ☐ Done items had their outcome measured
- ☑ Mix compared with the target

Next review: Tuesday 3 June

"What would we stop to make room for this?"

"Which initiative, if it were the only one, would we finish first?"

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